

dropIn: McGill Scheduling Hub



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Introduction

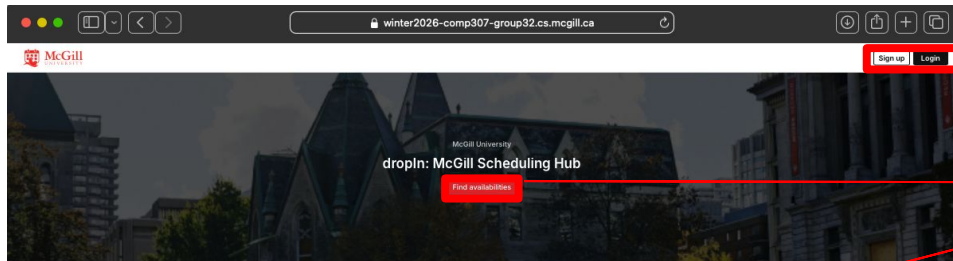
This deck presents the main features and user flow of our scheduling platform, highlighting how students and professors can manage appointments, course events, availability, and group scheduling through role-specific dashboards. More information and a detailed walkthrough will be shown in our demo video.

Demo Video Link :

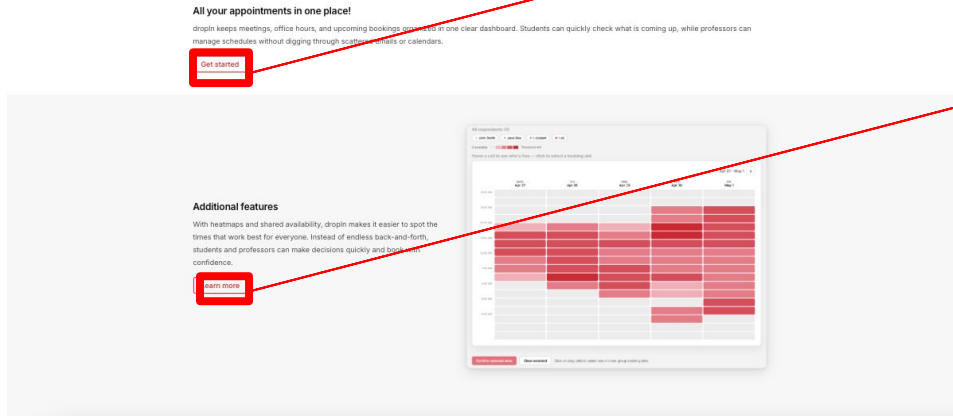
<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JYRFMObb3FcYsd3zfliB6xk6XYWu8ydm/view?usp=sharing>

Landing Page

The landing page introduces dropIn with a clean overview of the platform and guides users toward exploring its core features.



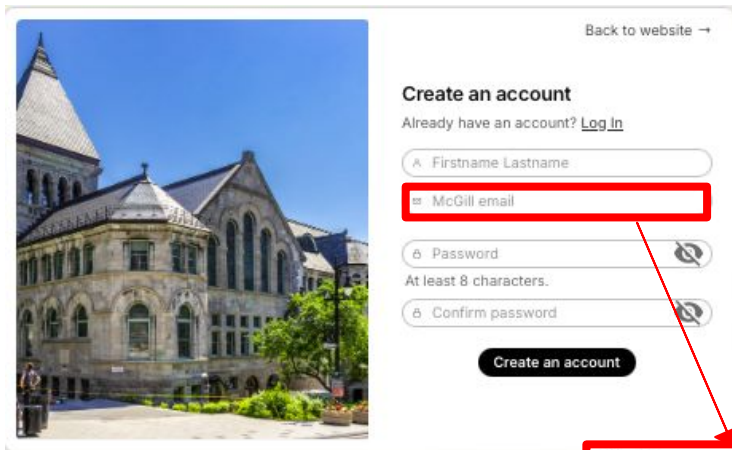
The **Sign Up** button directs new users to create an account, while **Login** takes returning users to the authentication page. The **Find Availabilities** button leads users to search for available meeting times, and **Get Started** guides them into the main flow of using dropIn.



The **Learn More** button directs users to the accordion section, where they can expand items to read more details about dropIn's features, purpose, and how the platform works.

Sign up/ Login

The Sign Up page allows new users to create an account by entering their required information and selecting their role. The Login page lets existing users securely access their account using their credentials.



Back to website →

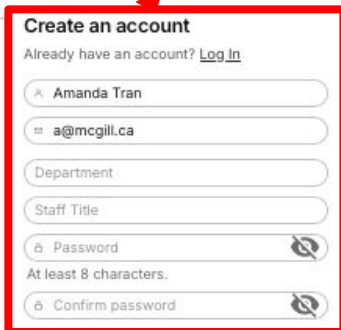
Create an account

Already have an account? [Log In](#)

At least 8 characters.

Create an account

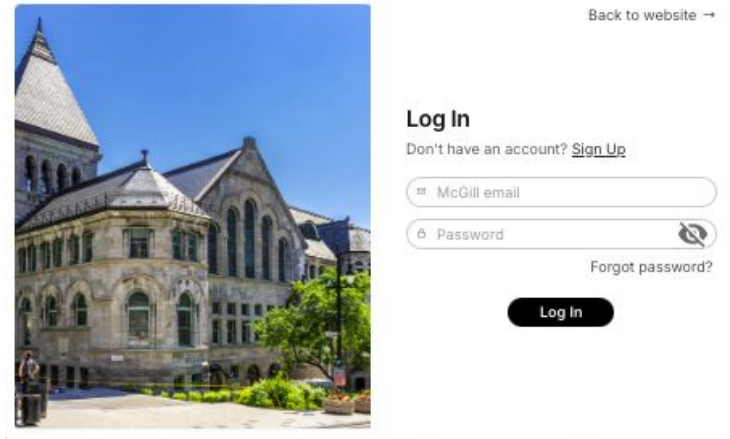
dropIn uses the email domain to determine the account type: users who sign up with a mail.mcgill.ca address are registered as students, while users with a mcgill.ca address are treated as professors or staff and must provide additional information during sign up.



Create an account

Already have an account? [Log In](#)

At least 8 characters.



Back to website →

Log In

Don't have an account? [Sign Up](#)

Forgot password?

Log In

The **Forgot Password** feature helps users recover access if they cannot remember their password.

Student Dashboard

After logging in as a student, users are directed to the Student Dashboard, where they can view their upcoming appointments, respond to availability requests, search for professors, and manage their schedule through the sidebar navigation.

McGill Dashboard Calendar

Ding, shirley Student

Hide panel Log Out

Calendar

Courses

Search

Sync Calendar

Export Calendar

Help

April 2026

Today < April 26 – May 2, 2026 >

Upcoming appointments

No upcoming appointments.

EDT SUN 26 MON 27 TUE 28 WED 29 THU 30 FRI 1 SAT 2

6am

7am

8am

9am

10am

11am

12pm

1pm

2pm

3pm

4pm

5pm

6pm

7pm

8pm

9pm

Group heatmap

Heatmap invitations

* Prof LGTM
COMP307 heatmap
Approved

The Student Sidebar gives students quick access to the main parts of the application:

- **Calendar** brings students back to their dashboard/calendar view, where they can see their scheduled appointments and availability-related events.
- **Courses** opens the courses page, where students can view or join course-related spaces and access course appointments.
- **Search** takes students to the professor search page, where they can find professors and book available meeting times.
- The **Sync Calendar** feature lets students connect their schedule with an external calendar, helping them keep track of appointments and availability in one place.
- **Export Calendar** lets students export their schedule so they can add it to an external calendar.
- **Help** opens a guide with information about how to use the student dashboard features.

Professor Dashboard

After logging in with a professor or staff email, the user is routed to the Professor Dashboard, where they can manage their calendar, create appointments or availability slots, organize course events, and use heatmaps to coordinate meeting times with students.

The screenshot displays the McGill University Professor Dashboard Calendar. The interface includes a sidebar with a 'Create' button (highlighted with a red box), a calendar grid for April 2026, and a 'Create event' form (highlighted with a red box). The form contains fields for event title, date, start/end time, location, capacity, visibility, recurrence, color, course, and description. A red box also highlights a time slot on the calendar grid. Another red box highlights the 'Heatmap tools' section, which includes a '+ Create new heatmap' button and a description of how to use heatmaps.

The Professor **Sidebar** gives the professor quick access to the main parts of dropIn (similar to the students but the Help provides guidance for the professor user instead of the student user).

The **right panel** on the Professor Dashboard is a professor-only feature that gives instructors a quick overview of upcoming appointments and **heatmap-related activity**. Unlike the student dashboard, it also supports professor workflows such as managing availability, reviewing scheduling requests, and accessing heatmap tools for coordinating meetings with students.

Professors can create appointments with students in multiple ways from the Professor Dashboard:

- The **Create** button on the left sidebar opens a form where professors can create a new event or availability slot for students to book.
- Professors can also **drag and select a time directly on the dashboard calendar**, which quickly opens the creation form with the selected time already filled in.
- In addition, professors can **create heatmaps** to collect student availability, compare responses, and schedule appointments based on the times that work best for everyone.

Professor Courses

The Professor Courses page allows professors to view **active** and **archived** courses, **create new courses**, **filter courses by semester**, and **open individual course pages**. Inside a course, professors can **manage course details**, **share or regenerate invitation links** for students, add teaching assistants (one at a time) by McGill email, and view the teaching staff list. Professors can also **create course events** through calendar bookings or heatmap bookings, edit or delete scheduled events, export the course calendar, and close or delete a course when needed.

The screenshot displays the McGill Professor Courses interface. On the left, the 'Course List' sidebar shows a list of active courses. The 'Summer 2026' course 'COMP550 NPL' is highlighted with a red box. A red arrow points from this box to the detailed course view on the right. The detailed view shows the course name 'COMP550 NPL', the semester 'Summer 2026', and options to 'Copy invitation link' and 'Regenerate link'. Below this, the 'Teaching staff' section lists 'Test Professor' as the instructor. On the right side of the detailed view, there is a 'TEST Availabilities for course' section showing a date range from May 2, 2026, at 10:00 AM to May 2, 2026, at 12:30 PM, with 0/3 attendees.

Course List

Summer 2026

Active

Summer 2026 Owner

COMP550

NPL

Archived

No archived courses.

COMP550

NPL

Summer 2026

< Copy invitation link

Regenerate link

Teaching staff

Test Professor
Instructor · McGill University

TEST Availabilities for course

May 2, 2026 at 10:00 AM – May 2, 2026 at 12:30 PM ...

Attendees: 0/3

Student Courses

The Student Courses page allows students to view the courses they have joined, browse active and archived courses, and filter courses by semester. When students open a course, they can see course information, teaching staff, instructor contact options, and course-related events in either a list or calendar view. Students can also join available course events when space is available and export the course calendar to keep track of upcoming meetings or activities.

This is what the students see when they select a specific course that they are enrolled into.

The screenshot shows the McGill University 'Course' page for COMP550 NPL. The page is divided into a left sidebar and a main content area. The sidebar contains icons for 'Calendar', 'Courses' (highlighted with a red box and an arrow pointing to the main content), 'Search', 'Export Calendar', and 'Help'. The main content area displays course details for 'COMP550 NPL' for 'Summer 2026'. It includes a 'Teaching staff' section listing 'Test Professor' as the instructor at McGill University, with an 'Availability' button. To the right, there are tabs for 'List' and 'Calendar', and an 'Events' section showing 'TEST Availabilities for course' from May 2, 2026, at 10:00 AM to May 2, 2026, at 12:30 PM, with a 'Join' button. The top of the page features the McGill University logo, the word 'Course', a user profile for 'Ding, shirley' (Student) with a 'Log Out' button, and a notification bell icon.

Professor Booking Search Page

The Professor Booking Search page allows students to search for professors by name, department, or email and open a professor's booking page. After selecting a professor, students can view the professor's currently available public time slots, choose an open slot, and submit a booking request. Once the request is submitted, the appointment is created as pending and the professor receives a notification so they can confirm or respond to the booking.

The screenshot displays the McGill Professor Booking Search interface. It includes a top navigation bar with the McGill logo, a search bar, and user profile information. The main content area is divided into two sections: a calendar view on the left and a search results view on the right. The calendar view shows a grid of dates for May 2026, with a sidebar for creating availability slots. The search results view shows a list of professors, with a detailed view for 'Test Professor' showing their availability slots and a booking confirmation message.

1 Professor, Test Professor, TP, panel | Log Out

2 The professor must create some availabilities for the students to submit a booking request

3 Ding, shirley Student | Log Out

4 Search

5 Find a professor to book with

Search professors by name, department, or email to view booking availability.

Test Prof

6 View availability

7 Test Professor

ARTS • Instructor
Department: ARTS
Staff Title: Instructor
tp@mcgill.ca | Contact | Copy booking link

Your booking is confirmed! It will appear on your dashboard shortly.

Select a Date & Time

May 2026

SUN MON TUE WED THU FRI SAT

1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8 9 10 11 12 13 14 15 16 17 18 19 20 21 22 23 24 25 26 27 28 29 30 31

Available appointment day

Selected slot

Meeting with Test Professor
Wed, May 6
11:00 AM - 12:00 PM
Online meeting
Capacity Booked 0/1

Confirm booking

Back to dashboard

McGill

Heatmap(1/3): Professor

The heatmap feature lets a professor collect student availability before creating a meeting. The professor first creates a heatmap with a title, optional course, and description, then marks their own available times on a grid. The professor can save those slots as one-time availability or repeat them across multiple weeks, then share the heatmap link with specific students.

McGill
UNIVERSITY

Heatmap

Test Professor
Professor

Log Out

Calendar

Courses

Search

Set your availability

Mark when you're free. Choose whether slots repeat weekly.

COMP 550

No description added yet.

Edit details

Delete heatmap

My availability

Click and drag to mark times you're free. Set recurring or one-time.

Availability heatmap

See all students' availability at once. Darker cells = more students free.

Set the date range

Choose which week and hours to display on the grid.

Start date

End date

From

To

2026-05-02

2026-05-06

8:00 AM

5:00 PM

Apply

Click or drag to mark availability

<

May 2 - May 6

>

	SAT May 2	SUN May 3	MON May 4	TUE May 5	WED May 6
8:00 AM					
9:00 AM					
10:00 AM					
11:00 AM					
12:00 PM					
1:00 PM					
2:00 PM					
3:00 PM					
4:00 PM					

☒ One-time only

visible for 2026-05-02 - 2026-05-06

☐ Recurring

repeat for

4 weeks

Save for this week

Clear all

Share invite link

21 slots selected



Heatmap(2/3): Student

On the student heatmap page (accessed through the link shared by the professor/TA), students only select from the professor's available slots. The unavailable cells stay inactive, while the professor's available cells can be clicked or dragged over. After choosing the times that work for them, students submit their availability, which is saved as a pending response for the professor to review. If other students have already responded, students may also see darker shading on shared slots, showing that more classmates are available at those times.

McGill Heatmap

shirley Ding
Student **GD** Log Out

Book a slot
Select times that work for you from Test Professor's available slots.

Select your slots
Pink cells are the professor's available times.

Showing **May 2 - May 6** of 5 days, 9:00 AM - 1:00 PM **Change**

Professor available Your selection Not available

Select from the professor's available slots

< May 2 - May 6 >

	SAT May 2	SUN May 3	MON May 4	TUE May 5	WED May 6
9:00 AM					
10:00 AM					
11:00 AM					
12:00 PM					

Submit availability **Clear** 3 slots selected

Calendar
Courses
Search
Export Calendar
Help

Heatmap(3/3): Submission Confirmation

Back on the professor heatmap page, the professor can switch from **My Availability** to **Availability Heatmap** to see all student responses combined. When multiple students respond, each student appears as a participant chip, and the professor can include or exclude students from the group view. The heatmap cells become darker when more selected students are available at the same time, and hovering over a cell shows which students are free. The professor can then select one or more strong time slots and confirm them, creating appointments with the available students for those selected times.

The professor/TA can view if there are any new heatmap submission on the right sidebar. Clicking the panel will lead to the heatmap page. The submission is viewed in **Availability heatmap** where the most desired time from a group is the darkest colored slot. The professor/TA can also hover over the slot to see the students who have chosen the slot.

Heatmap tools

+ Create new heatmap

Create a heatmap, share the link with students, and approve their submissions from the heatmap page.

1

- COMP 550
1 pending · 1 submission
Created May 2

Set your availability

Mark when you're free. Choose whether slots repeat weekly.

COMP 550
No description added yet.

Edit details Delete heatmap 2

My availability
Click and drag to mark times you're free. Set recurring or one-time.

Availability heatmap
See all students' availability at once. Darker cells = more students free.

Showing May 2 – May 6 of 5 days, 9:00 AM – 1:00 PM Change

All respondents (1)
shirley Ding

0 available Threshold 1/1
Hover a cell to see who's free — click to select a booking slot

3

	SUN May 3	MON May 4	TUE May 5	WED May 6
9:00 AM				
10:00 AM				
11:00 AM	Threshold reached (1/1): shirley Ding			
12:00 PM				

4

Confirm selected slots Clear selected Click or drag cells to select one or more group booking slots

After confirming the selected slot(s), the professor/TA and the student(s) can now view the confirmed booking on their respective dashboards.

Group heatmap booking

APPOINTMENT

Saturday, May 2
10:30 AM – 11:00 AM Confirmed

DETAILS

Title	Group heatmap booking
Location	Heatmap group booking
Description	Created from heatmap group confirmation
Visibility	private
Capacity	1

PEOPLE

SD shirley Ding shirley.ding@mail.mcgill.ca	confirmed
TP Test Professor Host tp@mcgill.ca	confirmed

2



THANK YOU!